DELHI PUBLIC SCHOOL JANKIPURAM
ANNUAL EXAMINATION: (2024-2025)
ENGLISH LANGUAGE & LITERATURE (184)
GRADE: IX

SET–I

Time – 3 Hrs. **M.M. 80**

Name- _____ **oll No.-** _____ **Date-** _____

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General Instructions:

Read the following instructions carefully and follow them:

1. *This question paper comprises 11 questions. All questions are compulsory.*
2. *The question paper contains THREE sections-*
   - *Section-A : Reading Skills*
   - *Section-B : Grammar and Creative Writing Skills*
   - *Section-C : Literature*
3. *Attempt questions based on specific instructions from each part.*

S. No	Section	Weightage
A	Reading Skills	20 Marks
B	Grammar & Creative Writing Skills	20 Marks
C	Literature	40 Marks

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SECTION A: READING (20 Marks)

A1. Read the passage given below carefully.

'Why does humanity need Superman?' writes Lois Lane, well a very relevant question, isn't it? Why do we need superheroes? Every time we watch a superhero movie we are enchanted by its action and the superheroes' capability of saving humanity, we all like superheroes for a reason. Yes, a reason!

Forget about super-strength, laser vision, or — our personal favourite — the ability to consume any type of matter in the universe; the best superhero power might just be the way they inspire and motivate us. From the youngest boy or girl wonders to the oldest Captains, each superhero has his own lesson to bestow on the next generation.

Whether it's Batman saving Gotham city, or Superman saving humanity, or right back to our motherland Krissh (yes you got it right, the Indian superhero) saving its fellow countrymen, we need them because they give us hope to fight the bad and the worst happening in today's time.

"Sometimes the truth isn't good enough. Sometimes people deserve more. Sometimes people deserve to have their faith rewarded," says Batman.

Yes, it is right we need faith in today's time when we know nothing is going right neither the politics nor the terrorism, people need hope and strength from superheroes. And that's why we need superheroes, they give us a sense of right to fight the injustice that is happening around us. "There is a superhero in all of us, we just need the courage to put on the cape," said Superman.

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"You either die a hero or live long enough to see yourself become the villain", Batman, The Dark Knight. So every time when we choose to see a superhero movie it gives us the idea to fight the unjust with our own ideas or capabilities.

Every child or even adult watches superhero movies which motivate them to rise above the injustice that is happening in the real world. It's not just about power; you and I can also be a superhero by just helping our neighbourhood, by standing against the wrong that is happening against them. Whether it be political or apolitical that is happening around us, can be fought with a thought of righteousness and courage.

From the day we are born, we are told that power corrupts and absolute power corrupts absolutely. But superheroes give our subconscious desire for greatness. They also teach us that the greatest power is incorruptibility. None of us will ever leap a tall building in a single bound, change the course of a mighty river or bend steel in our bare hands. But we can always return that lost wallet with the contents intact, tell the truth when it matters, stand our ground when it's easier to walk away or do unto others as we want them to do unto us.

On the basis of your understanding of the passage, answer the given questions.

1. Despite our age and status in life, few enigmatic qualities endear us to superheroes. Select the correct option from below: (1)
   i. Give over subconscious a desire for greatness
   ii. Have a lesson to be strong.
   iii. Inspire and motivate us.
   iv. Give us hope to fight the bad.
   a) i and iii
   b) ii and iv
   c) iii and iv
   d) i, ii, iii and iv

2. Identify the sentence where the word 'bestow' has been used incorrectly. (1)
   a) He was ever ready to take the blame on himself and bestow praise on the others.
   b) During the ceremony, the Prime Minister will bestow medals of honour to the brave soldiers who rescue their comrades.
   c) The king will bestow a title and land to the man who saved the princess.
   d) If you want to avoid a misunderstanding, I bestow you to consider your words before speaking.

3. There is a superhero in all of us; we just need the courage to put on the cape'. By this, Superman is implying that: (1)
   a) Cape is heavy and not everyone can bear it
   b) We all have special powers.
   c) The ability to fight the unjust with our own ideas or capability is present in all of us.
   d) Society needs superheroes

4. According to the writer, how can a common man become a superhero? (1)
   i. Bend steel in our bare hands.
   ii. Stand up against injustice, return that wallet intact.
   iii. Help around the neighbourhood.
   a) Only i
   b) ii and iii

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c) i and iii
d) i and ii

5. A superpower common to all superheroes that endears them to us is: (1)
   a) The ability to strategize.
   b) The ability to remain calm in the face of danger.
   c) The capability to motivate and inspire humans.
   d) The capability to lend a helping hand to humans.

6. Choose the option that suits best as the title for the passage. (1)
   a) Humans are superheroes.
   b) Humanity needs superheroes.
   c) Hope and strength.
   d) Human should help each other.

7. What are the two things we need to fight injustice today? (1)
   a) Super power and superhero
   b) Truth and faith
   c) Hope and strength
   d) Hope and confidence

8. The character which has not been used by the author. (1)
   a) Batman
   b) Superman
   c) Spider-Man
   d) Krrish

9. What is the central idea of the passage? (2)

A2. Read the passage given below carefully.

1) Cell phones have become a nearly universal aspect of contemporary western culture. In many locations, children of elementary school age regularly carry cell phones. Cell phones, however, are not always welcome, and, in some areas, cell phones are banned. The reasons for the ban involve health and safety. There are various reasons for not allowing cell phones in schools. Most schools have banned their usage completely.

2) It is not only the classrooms where there is a ban on the usage of the cell phones but it has been banned while driving too. Distracted driving is a major factor in serious and fatal automobile accidents. In the United States many locations have passed laws banning the use of cell phones while driving. Other laws allow cell phones to be used for conversation if they are connected to hands-free devices. Texting while driving poses a heightened risk because it involves taking one or both hands off the steering wheel in order to operate the telephone keypad. President Barack Obama issued an executive order banning texting while driving for federal employees in 2009. Teenagers are especially prone to texting while driving.

3) A survey was conducted to know the opinion of people on various reasons for banning the use of cell phones. The table given below shows the result.

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Reasons	Opinion in %
Health and Safety	50%
Distraction	25%
Accidents	20%
Others	5%

4) The original reason given for banning cell phones on airplanes was the risk of interference with sensitive cockpit equipment. Newer digital phones have been shown to present little or no risk to air navigation, though; several airlines have lifted bans on cell phone use. There are usually still restrictions involved with on-board cell phone use, such as limitations to a particular network. The United States has continued to ban cell phone use on airplanes. The House of Representatives went so far as to draft a bill called HANG UP (H.R. 5788 Halting Airplane Noise to Give Us Peace Act of 2008) although the bill never made it out of the committee. With airlines such as American Airlines introducing on-board Wi-Fi service, some commuters believe it is only a matter of time before cell phone use is also permitted, especially if the airlines are allowed to charge fees.

On the basis of your reading of the above passage, answer the following questions by choosing the most appropriate answer.

1. Why are cell phones not allowed in schools? (1)
   a) because of health and safety reasons
   b) because they distract in the class
   c) because these are expensive
   d) only (a) and (c)
2. Why have cell phones been banned while driving? (1)
   a) because they distract the attention of the public
   b) because they may lead to accident
   c) because they are very expensive
   d) None of the above

3. What was the reason to ban cell phones on airplanes? (1)
   a) Risk of interference with sensitive cockpit equipment
   b) Cell phone may be used as a bomb
   c) Network problem
   d) None of the above

4. Which one of the following is not true? (1)
   a) The United States has continued to ban cell phone use on airplanes.
   b) 40% of people believe that health and safety is the major reason for the ban on cell phones.
   c) Teenagers are especially prone to texting while driving
   d) None of the above.

5. Find the antonym of 'coarse' from paragraph 4. (1)
   a) Sensitive
   b) Opinion

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c) Federal
d) none of the above

6. Find a word in paragraph 1, which means the same as 'BASIC'. (1)
a) Elementary
b) Contemporary
c) Involve
d) none of the above

7. What is the tone of the author? (1)
a) Informative
b) Hopeful
c) Bleak
d) Sarcastic

8. What percent of the people believe that cell phones lead to road accidents? (1)
a) 50%
b) 25%
c) 20%
d) 5%

9. What is the purpose of the passage? (2)

SECTION B: GRAMMAR & WRITING SKILLS (20 Marks)

Grammar (10 Marks)

B1. Attempt ANY TEN of the following questions, as directed. **(10x1=10)**

1. **Read the dialogue given below and choose the correct option of narration.**

Suman: When will you be eighteen?
Geeta: I don't know.
Suman: Do you not celebrate your birthday?
Geeta: I have no memory of this.
Suman: Sorry, if I hurt you.

Suman asked Geeta when she would be eighteen. Geeta replied (A)_____
Suman further asked her if (B)_____her birthday. Geeta told her that she had no memory of that. Suman regretted and said that she was sorry if she had hurt her.

Choose the correct option.

(A)
a) that she didn't know.
b) that she didn't knew.
c) that she hadn't known.
d) that she doesn't know.

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(B)

a) she did not celebrate
b) she has not celebrated
c) she does not celebrate
d) None of the above.

2. **Fill in the blanks with suitable options of modals.**
I wish that you..... pass in the first division.
a) might
b) may
c) must
d) none

3. **Identify the error in the given sentence, from a school magazine report and supply the correction.**
In order to balancing the sentiments of the Eagles and the Hawks, the Student Council suggested a rematch between the teams.
Use the given format for your response.

error	correction

4. **Complete the given narrative, by filling in the blank with the correct option.**
As I was standing on the dock, looking out at the lake for the last time, a feeling of emptiness _____ over me like darkness.
a) will wash
b) has washed
c) will have washed
d) washed

5. **Identify the error and supply the correction, for the following sentence.**
Many peoples attended the funeral of the great man.

Use the given format for your response.

Error	Correction

6. **Fill in the blank with the correct verb given in the options.**
Rahul and his friends _____ also invited to the party.
a) is
b) was
c) had
d) were

7. **Neither you nor your sister should _____ to them.**
a) talk
b) talks
c) talked
d) talking

8. **Fill in the blanks with the correct determiner given in the options.**

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_____ of the two sisters is married.

a) Both
b) Every
c) Each
d) Any

9. Choose the correct options to fill in the blanks to complete the paragraph.

Information technology (i) _____ (change) the way we access information. Since its introduction in the 1980's, the internet (ii)_____ (become) cheap and common.

(i) a) changed b) has changed c) is changing d) had changed
(ii) a) had become b) is becoming c) became d) has become

10. Select the correct option to complete the narration of the dialogue between son and his father.

Father: Why did you go to the market today?
Son: I had to buy some material to do my project.
Father: Who gave you the project?
Son: My science teacher gave the project.

Father asked his son why he had gone to the market that day. Son replied that he had to buy some material to do his project. Father then asked him _____. Son replied that his science teacher had given the project.

a) who had given him the project
b) who gave him the project
c) who gave the project
d) who has given the project

11. Read the given sentence. Identify the error and supply the correction in the sentence.

She don't like chocolate ice-cream.

Use the given format for your response.

error	correction

12. Read the dialogue given below and choose the correct option of narration.

Biology teacher: I instructed you to draw the diagram of bacteria. Why did you submit a blank sheet?

Sameer: Sir, I had drawn the diagram of bacteria, but you can't see it because bacteria is not visible to the naked eye

The biology teacher had instructed Sameer to draw the diagram of a bacterial cell and asked him
(A) _____ a blank sheet. Sameer respectfully answered that he had drawn the diagram but
(B) _____ to the naked eye.

Choose the correct option.

(A)
a) why had he submitted
b) why he had submitted

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c) why has he submitted
d) why did he submit

(B)
a) he couldn't see it because it is not visible
b) he could not saw that because bacteria was not visible
c) he cannot see it because it was not visible
d) he couldn't see that because bacteria is not visible

Writing (10 Marks)

B2. You had been living in the same house for 15 years. Now you are shifting to another house. **Write a descriptive paragraph** to describe the old house and your feelings in 100-120 words. (5)

B3. Write a story in 100-120 words beginning with the following lines: (5)
"It was a cold, misty morning when I found an old, rusty key lying on my doorstep. Little did I know, this key would change my life forever."

OR

Write a diary entry in 100-120 words reflecting on a book or a movie that left a lasting impression on you and why.

SECTION C: LITERATURE (40 Marks)

C1. Read the following extracts carefully and answer ANY ONE of the following.

A) *Where they harness the swift reindeer*
To the sledges, when it snows;
And the children look like bear's cubs
In their funny, furry clothes:

1. Who does 'they' refer to in the above lines? (1)
2. Why are reindeers harnessed? (1)
3. Which literary device is used in the line 'In their funny, furry clothes:'? (1)
   a) Personification
   b) Alliteration
   c) Metaphor
   d) Allusion
4. What is a ballad? Is this poem a ballad? (2)

OR

B) *So hack and chop*
But this alone won't do it.
Not so much pain will do it.
The bleeding bark will heal
And from close to the ground
Will rise curled green twigs,
Miniature boughs
Which if unchecked will expand again
To former size.

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1. Identify the literary device used in the first line of the extract. (1)

2. Which word in the stanza means 'branches'? (1)
   a) bark
   b) boughs
   c) twigs
   d) none

3. The rhyme scheme used in the poem is: (1)
   a) abcd
   b) abcb
   c) aabb
   d) free verse

4. What is the central idea of the poem? (2)

C2. Read the following extracts carefully and answer ANY ONE of the following.

A) *This is your big surprise. I said you wouldn't kill me and I was right. Why do you think I am here today and gone tomorrow, never see tradespeople? You say my habits would suit you. You are a crook.*
Do you think I am a Sunday-school teacher?
The game's up as far as I'm concerned. Things went wrong with me. I said it with bullets and got away. Unfortunately, they got one of my men, and found things the fool should have burnt. Tonight I'm expecting trouble. My bags packed ready to clear off. There it is.

1. Who is speaking and to whom? (1)

2. What is the meaning of the phrase 'Sunday-school teacher'? (1)
   a) An honest man
   b) A teacher who works only on Sundays.
   c) A stupid person
   d) A criminal

3. Find the synonym of 'lawbreaker' from the above extract. (1)

4. What according to the speaker was a big surprise? (2)

OR

B) *At my slightest movement the snake would strike me! Death lurked four inches away. Suppose it struck, what was the medicine I had to take? There were no medicines in the room. I was but a poor, foolish and stupid doctor. I forgot my danger and smiled feebly at myself.*

1. What was the doctor doing before the snake landed on him? (1)
   a) Reading the book 'Materia Medica'.
   b) Admiring himself by looking into a mirror.
   c) Thinking of the creator of this world.
   d) Entering his room.

2. Why did 'I' refer to himself as poor, foolish and stupid doctor? (1)

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3. Find the word from the extract which means the same as 'something hidden'. (1)

4. How did the doctor react when he encountered the snake? (2)

C3. Answer ANY FOUR questions in 40-50 words. (4x3=12)

1. Who helped Evelyn to continue with music? How was she able to sense certain musical notes?

2. 'And the melancholy darkness gently weeps in rainy tears.' What is the source of the given line? Identify the poetic device used and explain the line.

3. How is the title 'A Truly Beautiful Mind' apt?

4. Why did Kezia admire Mr. Macdonald and fear her father?

5. Why does the author state, "To hear any flute is to be drawn into the commonality of all mankind"?

C4. Answer ANY TWO questions in 40-50 words. (2x3=6)

1. Why did the swallow not leave the Happy Prince and go to Egypt?

2. What is the central theme of the story 'In the Kingdom of Fools'?

3. Was Lushkoff a willing worker? Why did he agree to chop wood for Sergei?

C5. Answer ANY ONE question in 100 – 120 words. (1x6=6)

1. How does the life of Santosh Yadav demonstrate that determination and the right choice of path lead to success? Explain.

2. How did the doctor react when he encountered the snake? How does his patience and presence of mind reflect in his behaviour?

C6. Answer ANY ONE question in 100 – 120 words. (1x6=6)

1. How does the statement, "My cat was back and so was I," reflect the narrator's transitional journey from a troubled teenage boy to self-realisation? Support your answer with evidence from the text.

2. How does the chapter "The Last Leaf" illustrate that the willingness to live is more crucial than medication? Support your answer with evidence from the text.

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